

FORMIDABLE ARJUN GOES FROM ADVERSITY TO UBIQUITY



Breathing rarefied air: Arjun Erigaisi made history at the European Chess Club Cup by breaking into the exclusive 2800 rating club in the live chess ratings, which update in real time. To date, only 16 players worldwide have reached this milestone. LENNART OOTES / FIDE

Earlier this month, Arjun Erigaisi joined the **elite 2800 club** in classical chess, a milestone reached by only 16 Grandmasters in history. However, the journey was not always this smooth.

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Among the prominent military leaders of World War II, General George S. Patton Jr. stands out as a formidable figure. Famously known by the nickname 'Old Blood and Guts', Patton was celebrated for his unmatched vigour and ability to inspire American troops. His bold and aggressive tactics, particularly displayed through the sweeping advances of his Third Army across Europe at an unprecedented pace, were instrumental in securing several key Allied victories. His legacy endures as a symbol of courage and strategic success, marking him as one of history's most influential and daring commanders.

Arjun Erigaisi, the latest and youngest Indian to enter the prestigious 2800-rating club, mirrors Patton's battlefield tenacity in his on-the-board style. **Often emotionless and unyielding, his relentless pursuit of victory and his ability to pressurise opponents reflect Patton's own uncompromising approach in driving his men to secure rapid gains.**

In just one year, he has gained nearly 90 rating points, a leap that is rooted in his daring approach to each game. Five-time world champion Viswanathan Anand, who was the first Indian to cross the 2800-rating mark, describes this remarkable approach: "Arjun is trying this new approach of really raising the stakes in every game. He provokes a struggle, sometimes even accepting an inferior